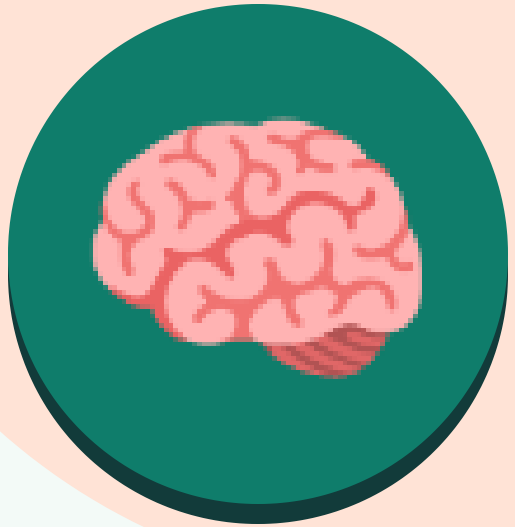
Health · Unit 3 · Level 2 (modified)

Substance Use & Abuse



TODAY'S PLAN

- 🧪 Substances and the brain
- 📈 Progression of use
- 🔄 Stages of change
- 🛡️ Risk and protective factors
- 💊 Fentanyl and naloxone
- 🔎 Checking sources

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



🥗 Last unit: what we put in our bodies matters.

🧪 A substance is anything that changes your mood or mind.

❓ Why do you think teens start using substances?

Words to Know

Words to Know



Substance

Anything that changes your mood or mind, like alcohol, nicotine, cannabis or opioids.



Brain development

The brain keeps developing until about age 25. The part for decisions (prefrontal cortex) finishes last.



Progression

Use can move from trying it, to mild, moderate and severe use.



Stages of change

Pre-contemplation, contemplation, preparation, action, maintenance.

Words to Know

More Words to Know



🛡️ **Protective factor**: Things that lower the chance of harm, like caring adults, activities and goals.

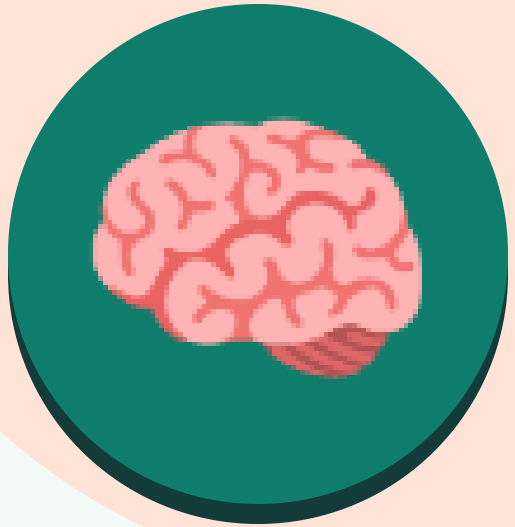
⚠️ **Risk factor**: Things that raise the chance of harm, like stress, peer pressure or easy access.

💊 **Fentanyl**: A very strong opioid. A tiny amount can cause an overdose. It is hidden in fake pills.

🚑 **Naloxone**: A nasal spray (Narcan) that can reverse an opioid overdose. Call 911 too.

Learn

Substances and the Brain



🧪 Examples: alcohol, nicotine, cannabis, opioids, stimulants.

🧠 The brain develops until about **25**.

🎯 The **prefrontal cortex** (decisions, self-control) finishes last.

⚠️ Using young raises the risk of addiction.

🃏 Check 1 of 4



Which brain part, for decisions, finishes developing last?

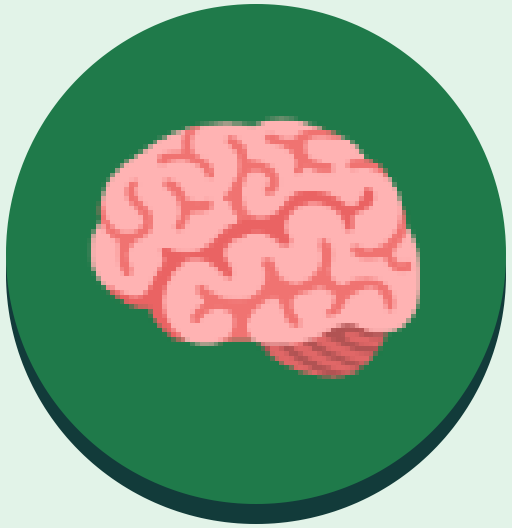
Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Stomach

2️⃣ Prefrontal cortex

3️⃣ Spinal cord

✅ Answer · Card 1 of 4



Prefrontal cortex

The prefrontal cortex finishes around 25.

Learn

Progression of Use



Experimentation
trying it



Mild
some use



Moderate
use causes problems



Severe
hard to stop, life changes

Learn

Stages of Change



1️⃣ **Pre-contemplation**: not thinking about changing.

2️⃣ **Contemplation**: thinking about it.

3️⃣ **Preparation**: making a plan.

4️⃣ **Action**: making the change. 5️⃣ **Maintenance**: keeping it up.

🔁 **Relapse** can happen. You can start again.

🃏 Check 2 of 4



Someone is making a plan to quit vaping. Which stage?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Maintenance

2️⃣ Pre-contemplation

3️⃣ Preparation



Preparation

Making a plan = preparation.

Compare

Risk vs. Protective Factors



⚠️

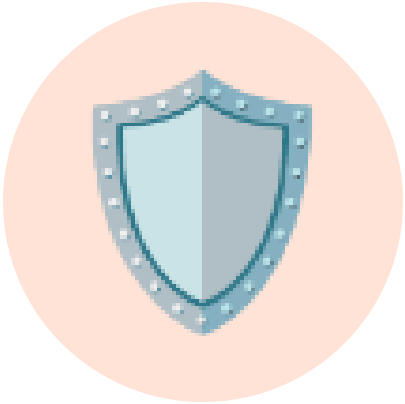
Risk factors

Stress or trauma
Friends who use
Easy access

Protective factors

Caring adults
Activities and goals
Coping skills

🃏 Check 3 of 4



Which is a protective factor?

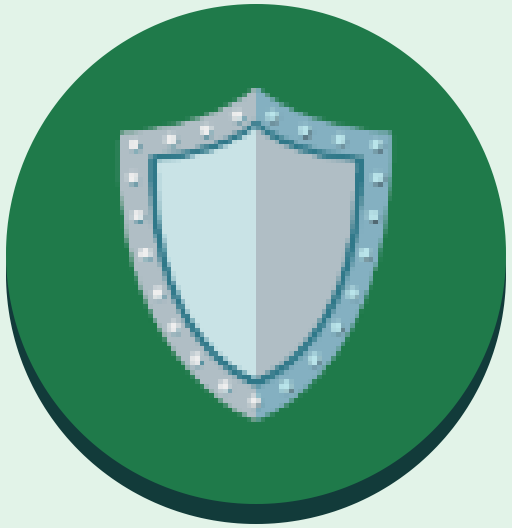
Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Being on a sports team

2️⃣ Easy access to alcohol

3️⃣ Lots of stress

✅ Answer · Card 3 of 4



Being on a sports team

Activities protect.

Learn

Alcohol and Overdose



🍺 Alcohol causes about **178,000** U.S. deaths a year.

📉 Overdose deaths: **81,313** (2024) → **69,973** (2025).

💊 Most overdose deaths involve **fentanyl**.

Learn

Fentanyl and Naloxone



💊 Fake pills can contain **fentanyl**. A tiny amount can kill.

🚑 Signs: won't wake up, slow breathing, blue lips.

📞 **Call 911.** Give **naloxone** (Narcan) if you have it.

⚖️ WA **Good Samaritan law** protects people who call for help.

🃏 Check 4 of 4



WA's Good Samaritan law protects people who...

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Sell drugs

2️⃣ Drive after drinking

3️⃣ Call 911 for an overdose

✅ Answer · Card 4 of 4



Call 911 for an overdose

It encourages calling for help.

Learn

Check Your Sources (CRAAP)



⏰ **C**urrency: is it recent?

🎯 **R**elevance: does it answer my question?

👤 **A**uthority: who wrote it?

✅ **A**ccuracy: is it backed up? 🎯 **P**urpose: why was it made?

Learn

Words Matter



🗣️ Say **“person with a substance use disorder,”** not “addict.”

💬 Person-first words lower shame.

🤝 Less shame helps people ask for help.

Wrap-Up

Recap



Brain
develops until 25



Stages
5 steps + relapse



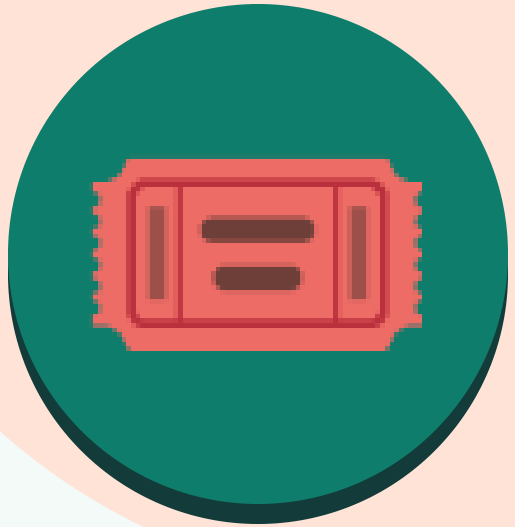
Protective
adults, goals



Overdose
911 + naloxone

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



1️⃣ Name one risk factor and one protective factor.

2️⃣ What should you do if someone won't wake up?

3️⃣ What does the C in CRAAP stand for?